Get into YC

Ambient Systems

Batch: 2022 Summer
Status:

Company Founders Progress Idea Equity Legal Others Curic

Company

If you have a demo, what's the url? Demo can be anything that shows us how the product works. Usually that's a video or screen recording.

https://www.loom.com/share/996ed19220244f83bf20686344ceac78

Describe what your company does in 50 characters or less.

Net Zero facilities for every business based on data science

What is your company going to make? Please describe your product and what it does or will do.

Ambient Systems is transforming the data-rich world of facilities management and analytics of large buildings and commercial real estate. We created a new data-driven way to build with the goal of decarbonizing real estate development, financing, and operation through an open source platform. The software gives REITs, property developers, and facility managers insight into their portfolios and enables them to create greater value by focusing on their customers and investors. The launch use case is a data-driven way to evaluate green building projects,

Where do you live now, and where would the company be based after YC?

Singapore, Singapore / TBD, US

Founders

Please enter the url of a 1 minute unlisted (not private) YouTube video introducing the founder(s). This video is an important part of the application. (Follow the Video Guidelines.)



How many founders are on the team?

1

Progress

How far along are you?

We've contacted over 570 industry professionals and conducted over 50 interviews to understand the market and test our hypothesis. During this time we've also launched the product MVP, which won a 1st runner up at a Google . We're now looking to validate whether the solution solves the initial problems identified. However, this has been more challenging as sometimes the prospective user who is facing the problem is not the decision maker who can end up purchasing the solution -- and vice versa. Therefore, we need investment to keep going to find exactly who 'feels' this problem the most within the company. Our hypothesis is that it's the CFO or the CSR function. We're now in early conversation with these groups to present the solution we've developed based on initial customer problem validation.

How long have each of you been working on this? How much of that has been full-time? Please explain.

We've been working on this idea since March

Are people using your product?

Yes

How many active users or customers do you have? If you have some particularly valuable customers, who are they? If you're building hardware, how many units have you shipped?

We have launched the product through a presentation and live demo at Google's Singapore office (APAC HQ), where we won a first runner-up spot out of 40+ teams and startups. The prototype is available to early adopters. We also have over 20 users who are currently using it and providing feedback. These include investors, facility managers, data scientists, and others.

Do you have revenue?

No

If you are applying with the same idea as a previous batch, did anything change? If you applied with a different idea, why did you pivot and what did you learn from the last idea?

N/A

If you have already participated or committed to participate in an incubator, "accelerator" or "pre-accelerator" program, please tell us about it.

We've completed several Singapore-based incubators to validate our hypothesis about the market: NUS GRIP, SMU BIG, CapitaLand Sustainability challenge and Google Hackathon.

Idea

Why did you pick this idea to work on? Do you have domain expertise in this area? How do you know people need what you're making?

Ivan Damnjanovic founded Ambient Systems based on several years of experience helping companies to adopt new sustainable energy technology. He worked at Deloitte Canada on consulting engagements with the mining sector, where he developed Big Data Analytics models to transition multiple mining sites to clean fuel and electricity, saving the company over $130MM per year on energy costs while maintaining ambitious production targets. He went on to work in Asia on developing 200+ solar energy projects through roles at various US, Australian, and German startup companies that were operating in emerging markets. Throughout these experiences, he discovered how difficult it was for the customer to evaluate the nuances of the tech solutions he was proposing, such as solar, smart grids, energy storage, or even biofuels. There was just way too many variables for them to consider -- and in many cases their in-house engineers did not have the expertise in these domains. Furthermore, other vendors in the market would provide pro-bono engineering consulting services to win over clients to their product, such as a particular brand of solar panels or batteries.

Ivan found this problem prevalent in emerging and developed markets in both Canada and Asia. He went on to pursue a master's degree in computer science to solve this challenge, albeit the technical and financial considerations at first. During his postgraduate studies, an idea was conceptualized that eventually emerged to become what is today Ambient Systems. Since launching in July 2021, Ivan has acquired numerous industry experts to advise the company on this journey. He's also assembled a very helpful team to address various challenges faced by the company at different stages.

What do you understand about your business that other companies in it just don't get?

We see net zero targets as fundamentally a financial dilemma, dealing with capital allocation and re-allocation. Based on years of experience, we recognize the technical nuances specific to the property development sector. Most companies focus on carbon-related indicators to estimate . We look at the fundamental source of the emissions, whether material production or energy consumption, and multiple it by the emission intensity from reputable academic sources.

How do or will you make money? How much could you make?

We make money through a B2B SaaS subscription model. We charge based on the number of datafeeds the customer is purchasing from us -- to augment their dataset -- and based on the number of machine learning models they're leveraging to achieve their net zero targets. The price of these two revenue streams are competitive with the market alternatives, such as sourcing the data in-house or assembling an in-house teams to build similar machine learning models that we've deployed.

Equity

Have you incorporated, or formed any legal entity (like an LLC) yet?

Yes

What kind of entity and in what state or country was the entity formed?

Ambient Systems Pte. Ltd. (Singapore)

Have you issued stock to investors?

Yes

Have you raised money using crowdfunding?

No

Please describe the breakdown of the equity ownership in percentages among the founders, employees and any other stockholders. If there are multiple founders, be sure to give the equity ownership of each founder.

Founder: 100%

holders: NUS, Private Investor

Have you taken any investment yet?

Yes

List any investments your company has received. Include the name of the investor, the amount invested, the premoney valuation / valuation cap, and the type of security sold (s, safes or stock).

National University of Singapore: $100k (, 20% discount)
Private investor: $30k (, up to 3% equity conversion upon fundraising milestones)

How much money do you spend per month?

$8,000

How much money does your company have in the bank now?

$3,000

How long is your runway?

End of runway

Please provide any other relevant information about the structure or formation of the company.

N/A

Legal

Are any of the founders covered by noncompetes or intellectual property agreements that overlap with your project? If so, please explain.

N/A

Who writes code, or does other technical work on your product? Was any of it done by a non-founder? Please explain.

Ivan Damnjanovic is both the technical and business founder. He writes the machine learning models and does a lot of the data engineering himself. He usually has support on front-end app development from a domain expert. Company owns all code and IP.

Have you received any government grants?

No

Is there anything else we should know about your company?

N/A

Others

If you had any other ideas you considered applying with, please list them. One may be something we've been waiting for. Often when we fund people it's to do something they list here and not in the main application.

N/A

Please tell us something surprising or amusing that one of you has discovered.

After consuming a green smoothie, your body will naturally produce anti-inflammatory compound coenzyme Q10 when exposed to the sun (thanks to the chlorophyll circulating in your blood after consumption). This is the closest people have gotten to producing energy naturally from the sun! (i.e., photosynthesis)

Curious

What convinced you to apply to Y Combinator? Did someone encourage you to apply?

We have been in the works with Ambient for a considerable time, and with the traction made in the last half of the year has given us the confidence to apply for Y Combinator.

How did you hear about Y Combinator?

Word of mouth

Comments

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0 Comments